

OREGON CITY COURIER

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BARBAROUS AMERICA

Barbarous Mexico once upon a time came to the public attention through the misdirected, feloniously designed and altogether disreputable efforts of one Mr. Turner, who sojourned in the land then ruled by the iron hand of that master of statecraft, Porfirio Diaz. Friend Turner, a tourist in an unknown land, ambitious of pen, imaginative of mind, and unfamiliar with the rules of common truth telling, pictured Barbarous Mexico to us as a most formidable conglomerate of awfulness.

Turner was just one of dozens who have traveled through that much maligned nation with a camera and a note book, building scenes for his pictures and stretching his imagination to the utmost to fill his sordid note book. We have had a special hankering to pick on this fellow Turner for several years and we lose no opportunity for doing so. This is because such men as Turner, although he perhaps made no such childish impossible statements in his Barbarous Mexico, have picked on Mexico since old Hidalgo's was the master hand.

With Mexico's lawlessness, inspired in part by the craven raving of such as Turner, much in the public mind just now, it is timely to compare the barbarousness of that nation with that characteristic of our own peaceful, law-abiding and sane country. There has been so much said about it that the average American, untraveled on foreign soil, actually believes that if you look out of the corner of your eye at a Mexican the cool steel of his knife will seek your heartstrings the very next moment.

There is an actual fear, among that class of Americans which should at least be graced with common sense, that a Mexican is not human. Suffice to say, the Mexican is not more than half so prompt at stabbing friend or stranger in the back as many men on the streets of American cities are to shoot from ambush or crack you on the head for the half dollar in your pocket.

All of which has come to mind after reading the annual report of the accomplishments of the several and sundry lynchings held in the United States within the past year. Barbarous Mexico, when she was at the height of her wicked barbarity, never dared dream of the record of crime that has been piled up against our own clean United States, the producer of such men as Turner, who can blacklist a nation as barbarous and return to the United States to live in fearless peace.

Briefly, Mexico, with all her history, pictured gruesomely to those who believe all they read, would lie with the shame of the thing if her papers published such a statement as the Associated press sent out on the first day of the bright new year. The statement says:

"Fifty-four persons were lynched in the United States in 1916, according to records of Tuskegee institute, made public at Tuskegee, Ala., January 1. Fifty of the victims were negroes and four white persons, and included in the record are three negro women. Sixty-seven persons were lynched in 1915, 13 of whom were white men."

Apparently the only difference between Barbarous Mexico and Barbarous America is the fact that Mexico's barbarity is confined to the banditry and the armies of bandit leaders, while in America anybody or any gang can take a negro, perchance a woman or white man, and hang him to the sturdy oak in the court house square. Mexican police officials used to jail and punish the perpetrators of such fiendishness, yet she is a Barbarous Mexico.

SECRECY

Our customer's relations with us are held in complete confidence. The amount of money you have on deposit with us—your business relations with us—are never disclosed to anyone, except yourself. Any person can obtain information about our own affairs, but when you carry your money here no one can obtain information about your affairs.

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COUNTY DIVISION

Civic organizations and their incoordinated efforts notwithstanding, it appears that Clackamas county will lose a part of itself when the legislature gets through debating the question at the coming session.

As is usual when a crisis presents itself, there has been a great deal of talk on one side and another about thwarting the ambitions of a few individuals and one big company in the Oswego neighborhood. Thus far, however, the ambitions are growing, rather than being smothered, and a reasonable view of the situation is that Multnomah county will gain a favored section of new territory with little further effort.

While Oregon City and the rest of the county sits back on the haunches of inactivity, Oswego, aided and abetted by A. King Wilson, the worthy mayor of that hamlet, and the Oregon Iron & Steel company, Ladd estate realty promoters, is progressing constantly with plans for the division. It is a fact that Mr. Wilson and his compatriots—there are few of the other residents of Oswego who have this division bug in their bonnets—have lined up many members of the legislature and have pledged their votes in favor of a division when the matter is presented at Salem.

Within the past few days a frog has lodged in the throat of certain sections of Washington county. Portland business people have taken up homes in Washington county over extensive territory and they are ambitious to become a part of Multnomah county, along with our own favored Oswego territory. That does not relieve the local situation. It merely adds to the probability that Multnomah county will grow at the expense of the two adjoining counties.

A King Wilson, who bears the brunt of action on behalf of the Oregon Iron & Steel company, makes it appear that he would be satisfied with a paved road between Oswego and Portland and between Oswego and the Washington county line. He admits in his simple, weightless arguments that taxation would not be reduced. He does not deny that Multnomah county has a bonded indebtedness of three millions of dollars. He does not deny that Oswego and the residents thereof who have been inveigled into this division affair would be forced to share in that burden. He does not know, as a matter of fact, that Multnomah county would build hard surfaced roads any sooner than will Clackamas county, which, in spite of the low valuation of the district, has promised a road program for the coming summer.

In short, Mr. Wilson's arguments are so pointless that their very dictation reveals a veiled and mysterious ambition. If Mr. Wilson is actively connected with the Ladd realty scheme, conducted by the Oregon Iron & Steel company, his ambitions are obvious. Otherwise they seem childish or deceptive things, unworthy of a man of Mr. King's station in life. Of course, his whole interest is centered in Multnomah county. His business and his friends are in Portland. The promoters of this scheme would have us believe that road questions are the principal bone in the crav. They cannot get to Oregon City because of lack of transportation, but a good road to Portland would be a wonderful thing for them. The truth of the matter is that these persons would not come to Oregon City if they could and they would bleed the county seat for the profit of the metropolis.

The road questions are not all. They are a minor point. Realty value about Oswego lake, and the value of other property owned by A. King Wilson, the Oregon Iron & Steel company, and others of the same complexion, would be greatly increased by inclusion in Multnomah county.

Mr. Wilson has not and will not deny that this is his greatest thought and the chief idea in the minds of a few of his ilk who are laboring for the division.

The trouble is that the division will actually be made in spite of the remainder of the county. Action has been so far delayed in Oregon City and elsewhere in the county, while Oswego and its patron saints have worked in the opposite direction, that drastic measures must be adopted now if that portion of the county is to be saved.

If the division is made it can be charged directly to that famous brand of business that uses its whole energy vocally and forgets that other activity is a necessity in the accomplishment of any task. Talk without action is a priceless evil.

STOCK GAMBLERS

The big gamblers in stocks are very much annoyed by Mr. Wilson's peace activities. They feel that they should be consulted and have a chance to unload their war stocks on the little peoples before those little people know that peace is really coming—that it is here.

The president sends to Europe a peace message that the whole world applauds. The secretary of state explains that conditions have become intolerable, that we not only ask but demand peace.

Thereupon the stock gamblers send to all the newspaper offices the statement that the administration is gambling in stocks—anonymous accusations, of course.

And a resolution is actually introduced in congress requesting that stock gambling by higher administration officials be investigated.

It will be interesting to see what reply the administration makes to the suggestion that peace should be delayed to suit the convenience of the big stock gamblers who want an opportunity—peace having taken them by surprise—to unload their stocks on the public.

That peace is here, that the war is over, these big stock speculators well know.

They realize that the closing of the Japanese stock exchange expresses the opinion of the Japanese government, which is one of the allies, and knows whether peace is coming or not.

But these big men of the stock gambling world feel that their interests are more important than peace, that the president should consult their gambling operations and not interfere with them, and they openly accuse his administration.

It is to be hoped that small investors will not allow themselves to be deceived.

Not one of the really big serious men of finance would advise anybody to invest a dollar in speculation at this moment, with peace coming.

Jacob Schiff, Judge Gary, Adolph Lewisohn, any one of the big bankers would say to the little man, "Don't let the gamblers deceive you. Keep your money in your pocket. Peace is here and there must be readjustment of values, and great caution."

The reply of the administration to the stock gambling accusation ought to be interesting. Unfortunately, it will not make easy the path of big American manufacturers, captains of industry, who will soon be in Washington begging for tariff protection against the European competition that will immediately start now the war is over.

To our readers we say the war is over. Peace is here. Keep your money and keep away from stock gambling. You will thank us for this advice in a few weeks.—New York Journal.

TOURIST MONEY

A bunch of boosters, backed by northwestern scenic assets, are creating a young fortune for the exploitation of the scenic beauties of this great wonderland, and Oregon's industrious motorists and commercial interests are anxious to have our pet at Salem, the legislature, appropriate a nice little bank account to pay eastern publications and other mouthpieces of publicity for telling our eastern friends that we have a very beautiful Crater lake, and wonderful Mount Hood, a magnificent Columbia River highway.

But here is a misdirection of ambitions. The Courier believes that an appropriation to cover the cost of exploiting our scenic resources would be that much waste. Therefore, we cannot favor it, although the concerted efforts of influential Portlanders will probably be successful in gaining the funds asked from the state. At the proper time we shall be highly pleased to contribute our mite toward the publicity fund, and we shall not wait because eastern magazines are packing their treasuries with Oregon money. But publicity, when the proper and cordial reception of tourists attracted thereby is an utter impossibility, seems an unwise expense. Only a short time ago we read with interest of plans for a beautiful and massive hotel building on the Columbia river highway. The plans were evidently used to paper the walls of the dream castle of their father.

How really unprepared this new and growing state is for the reception and proper entertainment of visitors is shown by the recent report

MOTHER SUPERIOR

Says Vinol Creates Strength
Rosary Hill Home, Hawthorne, N. Y.—"I have used Vinol for many run-down, weak or emaciated patients with benefit. One young woman was so weak and ill she could hardly creep to my door for aid. I supplied Vinol to her liberally and in a month I hardly recognized her. She was strong, her color charming and her cheeks rounded out."—MORRIS M. ALZONZA, LAWYER, O. S. D.
We guarantee Vinol to sharpen the appetite, aid digestion, enrich the blood and create strength.

Huntley Bros. Co., Druggists, Oregon City. Also at the leading drug stores in all Oregon towns.

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Don't Envy the City Man's Home Make Him Envy Yours!

The city man envies the ruralite for his pure air, his elbow room and his broad gauge life in general but he pities him for one thing—His Water Supply. A few years ago and this pity was well founded, but now the shoe is on the other foot.

THE Mitchell Water System

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To use as MUCH water as you wish WHEN YOU WISH, to have as MANY faucets as you want WHERE you want them at no extra cost; to regulate your own pressure—as MUCH or as LITTLE as you wish; to use your water for gardening—irrigating—sprinkling or for whatever other purpose you may desire. That's why a MITCHELL WATER SYSTEM gives you the best of the City Man.

The Mitchell Water System supplies you with unlimited dependable supply of pure cool water at no more cost (usually not as much) per month than is paid by the average city man for his restricted supply. This is not so of other water systems, which often are a source of a great deal more trouble than service owing to improper construction or poor installation. We have installed hundreds of Mitchell Systems in all parts of the Northwest—they are giving satisfaction to every buyer. Why, if given the opportunity, will gladly give you the benefit of our six years' experience in the pneumatic water supply line. We will plan for your home a Mitchell System that will exactly fit your requirements—that will give you service which will please you now and continue to do so for years and years—that's our policy—COMPLETE AND PERMANENT SATISFACTION TO EVERY BUYER—and we have the goods that uphold every claim we make for them. Write us today for our free book on country and suburban water supply systems. Ask for book.

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MR. REYNOLDS of Clackamas, Oregon, has a MITCHELL SYSTEM.



W. J. WILSON & CO., Oregon City Agent

of Stephen T. Mather, assistant secretary of the interior. Mr. Mather says of Crater lake park, one of the resources our money would help to make attractive to tourists:

"Hotel accommodations in Crater lake national park have never been satisfactory, and this year there was no improvement over former years. The development of accommodations and transportation service in this park must be undertaken on the same broad scale that the new concessions in Yosemite and Mount Rainier are now being handled."

Other Oregon out-of-door attractions are in the same condition as the famous Crater lake park. It would be foolhardy, unprofitable and shortsighted to attempt to bring thousands of tourists picture land of ours when we are unable to care for them. If the state or individuals care to properly develop national park concessions and other public properties, then Oregon can call the tourist and enjoy from the trade a lasting and profitable patronage.

A BRIGHT YEAR AHEAD

Governor James Withycombe, greeting readers of the new year's edition of the Oregonian, says: With bountiful crops during the last year and bright prospects for another season of great production, Oregon well may face 1917 with satisfaction and assurance. We have been slow to feel the full effects of the prosperity which unprecedented world conditions have forced upon the eastern states, but now Oregon, too, is experiencing the quickened pulse of trade awakening in all the branches of her industries. The products of our fields, forests, streams and workshops are in demand and at profitable prices. And we well may look for a continued period of economic prosperity, and perhaps for even new fields of opportunity and expansion when the world war has ceased and international trade relations are re-established.

But our satisfaction with the peace and plenty which surrounds us at home should be tempered by the constant recollection of the strife and want which is laying waste so vast a portion of our neighboring lands. Today we should realize more than ever before the imminence and complexity of the problems of nations, and the fact that while fortune thus far has been kind to us, yet at any time, a single incident may plunge us into unprecedented difficulties. And such realization should make us sober-minded and each one ready to place his small contribution of patriotic loyalty and public service at the disposal of the nation, or whatever portion of the national establishment each may most readily support.

One of Oregon's great opportunities lies in the expansion of its trade with foreign lands. We should make every effort to equip ourselves to enter that field on a big scale. It will be one of the factors for immediately stimulating the industrial development of Oregon.

This is a time for economic growth, for commercial preparedness; and especially, to my mind, it is a time for renewed and sincere interest in those things which go to make and keep a nation truly great—love of country and honor to its flag.

THE COST OF EDUCATION

We do not know who first announced that the hope of democracy lies in education; and the fact is so obvious that no particular credit is due him, anyway. A million parrots—among whom we occasionally enroll ourselves—repeat the statement every year; but it is not generally believed. If this democracy believed that its hope lay in education it would be giving much more attention to that subject, says the Post.

The country is spending this year some five hundred million dollars on public schools—roughly from two-thirds to three-fourths as much as it spends on automobiles. If you doubt

that the country is giving much more attention to automobiles than it is to public schools, stop the first thousand men who pass any given corner, or start in any direction from any point and drop into the first thousand farmhouses you come to, and start a conversation, first on the subject of automobiles and next on the subject of public education. You will find, as to the first subject, a right lively interest and a considerable fund of information. You will find, as to the second subject, a rather vague interest and general notion that the schools are not nearly so efficient as they might be.

If we were really penetrated by a belief that the hope of democracy lies in education we should be spending five times five hundred million dollars on public schools; and a general notion that the schools are not nearly so efficient as they might be would cause us to sit up nights until we discovered ways of making them more suitable to the tremendous task of realizing democracy by equalizing opportunity, so far as that can be done.

MOOSE WILL BUILD

Lodgemen Let Contract for Construction of Modern Main Street Home

Construction of the new home of the Moose lodge of Oregon City, to be built on Main street at Eleventh, will be in the hands of A. F. Fisher, local contractor, to whom the contract was let by the building committee on Saturday. The building is to be of frame, three stories high and covering a ground space of 66 by 90 feet. It will be appointed in the most modern style and its equipment will be designed especially to provide every facility for lodge work.

WOMEN OF OREGON!

Women Everywhere Endorse this "Favorite"

Lents, Oregon.—"In my younger days I was greatly troubled with gas on my stomach; it gave me lots of trouble. I began using Dr. Pierce's medicine and received such relief that I can recommend them to others."

"I have raised a large family and am a great grandmother and have always insisted that my daughters-in-law use Dr. Pierce's Favorite Prescription when expecting to become a mother."—Mrs. B. F. SEELEY, 5411 9th Street, S. E.

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